

Group Rules and Team Contract

IDIG4110 – Modern Software Engineering · NTNU Gjøvik · Autumn 2026

Group project: design and partial prototyping of a digital twin of a smart home

This document is the internal agreement of our project group. It describes how we organize our work, how we communicate, how we make decisions, and how we handle problems, so that we can deliver the project (stakeholder identification, requirements elicitation, architecture design, prototyping, testing and validation, and the technical report) on time and at a quality all members can stand behind. It also supports the course learning outcome on inclusive, collaborative and effective teamwork. The agreement is binding for all members from the date it is signed and applies until the portfolio is submitted.

1. Group members

All members fill in their details and sign on the last page.

#	Full name	NTNU e-mail	Main role(s)
1	Aksel Wiersdalen	akselhw@stud.ntnu.no	Scrum Master
2	Vinjar Berland	vinjarab@stud.ntnu.no	Product owner
3	Ole Marius Glomsrud	olemgl@stud.ntnu.no	System architect
4	Fredrik Svendsrud	fredrksv@stud.ntnu.no	Design lead, HR
5	Nikolai Stubø	nikolos@stud.ntnu.no	Head researcher
6	Katharina Kivle	katharki@stud.ntnu.no	Development lead

2. Roles and responsibilities

Roles are about coordination, not about doing the work alone. Every member contributes analysis, design, prototyping and writing. Roles marked as rotating change every second week so that everyone gains experience and no single person carries the administrative load.

Role	Responsibility
Coordinator (rotating)	Calls meetings, prepares the agenda, keeps the backlog up to date, tracks deadlines, and is the group's contact point towards the supervisor.
Secretary (rotating)	Write short minutes for every meeting: decisions, assigned tasks, deadlines, absences. Minutes are committed to /docs/minutes in the GitHub repository within 24 hours.
Document manager	Owens the report template, structure, reference list and formatting; runs the final consistency and language check before every submission.
Technical lead	Owens the GitHub repository, branching strategy, issue board and build/run instructions for the prototype; makes sure the code base is reproducible for all members.
Quality & validation lead	Maintains the traceability from stakeholders and requirements to design and tests and plans the testing and validation activities.

Role	Responsibility
Stakeholder/domain lead	Keeps the smart-home domain knowledge, stakeholder list and assumptions log; prepares questions for elicitation activities.

3. Meetings

- **Fixed weekly meeting:** Mondays 15:00 and Wednesdays 15:00. Physical meetings are held on campus, digital meetings in the group's Discord voice channel. Additional meetings are agreed at least 24 hours in advance.
- **Attendance is mandatory.** Absence must be announced in the group chat as early as possible, and at the latest before the meeting starts.
- **Punctuality:** we start on time. Members who are more than 15 minutes late without notice are counted as absent from that meeting.
- **Preparation:** everyone arrives having done their assigned tasks or having reported in advance that they could not.
- **Agenda and minutes:** the coordinator shares an agenda before the meeting; the secretary writes minutes with decisions, tasks, owners and deadlines.
- **Quorum:** decisions can be made when at least half of the members are present. Members who are absent are bound by the decisions taken and must read the minutes.
- **Focus:** laptops and phones are used for project work during meetings; we avoid parallel private discussions.

4. Communication

- Working language is **English**, in meetings, in the repository and in all written deliverables.
- **Discord** is our channel for daily coordination, questions and quick decisions. We use separate topic channels (for example *#general*, *#requirements*, *#architecture*, *#prototype*, *#report*) so that discussions can be found again. Formal matters and all contact with the supervisor go by NTNU e-mail.
- **Response time:** Discord messages that require an answer are answered within 24 hours on weekdays. If you will be unavailable for more than two days, say so in advance in the group channel.
- Discord is for discussion, **GitHub is the source of truth**. Anything a decision or a deliverable depends on (documents, models, code, minutes) is committed to the repository – it must never live only in a chat thread or on a personal machine.
- We give feedback on the work, not on the person, and we assume good intentions. Disagreement is welcome; disrespect is not.

5. Work distribution, effort and deadlines

- The workload is divided as evenly as possible, and tasks are distributed so that every member works on both technical and written parts. Nobody ends up only writing or only coding.
- Expected individual effort is approximately **6 hours per week**. Members who consistently spend far less are expected to take on additional tasks.
- Every task on the board has an **owner**, a **definition of done** and an **internal deadline**.
- **Internal deadlines are set at least three days before the official course deadline**, so there is time for review, integration and formatting.
- If you realize that you cannot finish a task on time, you tell the group as soon as you know it – not on the deadline. Re-planning is easy; silence is not.
- Work that is finished is reviewed by at least one other member before it is considered done.

6. Decision-making

We aim for consensus. If consensus cannot be reached within a reasonable time, we vote and a simple majority decides; every member has one vote. In case of a tie, the coordinator of the period casts the deciding vote, or we ask the supervisor for advice. Significant decisions – especially architectural and technological choices and trade-offs – are documented in the minutes or in a short decision log with the alternatives considered and the rationale, so that they can be reused in the technical report. Once a decision is made, everyone commits to it, including those who voted against.

7. Tools, repository and documentation

We use **GitHub** for all code and files, and **Discord** for day-to-day communication.

- **GitHub** is used for both code and file storage. One repository holds the prototype and the project documentation, with the structure `/src`, `/docs`, `/models`, `/tests` and `/docs/minutes`. All members are added as collaborators on day one. Repository URL: <https://github.com/Aks-I/IDIG4110-group1>
- The report is written in Overleaf with one agreed template and reference style. The final PDF and the source files are committed to `/docs` in GitHub before every submission.
- We work in feature branches named *feature/<short-name>* and merge into **main** through pull requests that are reviewed and approved by at least one other member. No direct pushes to main.
- Tasks are tracked as **GitHub Issues** on a shared project board, each with an owner and a deadline, and pull requests reference the issue they close. Commit messages are short, descriptive and in English, and main must always be runnable using the instructions in the README.
- Diagrams, requirement lists and test results are versioned together with the code, not left as loose attachments in Discord. No secrets, API keys or personal data are ever committed.

8. Quality assurance of deliverables

- Every report chapter is peer-reviewed by a member who did not write it, and the document manager performs a final read-through of the whole report.
- We keep traceability: stakeholders → requirements → architecture → prototype → tests, so that claims in the report can be verified.
- All sources are cited using the agreed reference style; figures and tables are numbered and referred to in the text.
- Nothing is submitted that has not been read by the whole group. The version to be submitted is tagged in GitHub and uploaded well before the deadline, never in the last minutes.

9. Use of AI tools

AI-assisted software engineering is part of this course, and we may use AI tools for brainstorming, drafting, code support and review, within the rules given by the course staff and NTNU. Our internal rules are: (i) we follow whatever the course staff specify – if in doubt, we ask; (ii) AI output is treated as a draft that must be understood, verified and edited by a human before it enters a deliverable; (iii) the member who submits the content is fully responsible for its correctness; (iv) we document where and how AI tools were used, as required by the course and as material for the reflection part of the report; and (v) we never paste confidential or personal data into external tools.

10. Academic integrity

All submitted work is our own. We do not copy text, figures, code or results without proper citation and license compliance, and we follow NTNU's rules on cheating and plagiarism. Every member is individually responsible for the integrity of what they contribute, and the group is collectively responsible for what is submitted. Suspected breaches are raised immediately within the group and, if confirmed, with the course staff.

11. Conflicts, non-delivery and escalation

Problems are handled early, openly and in this order. Each step is documented in the minutes so that the process is transparent if the course staff have to be involved.

Step	What happens
1. Direct talk	The members involved talk to each other directly and try to solve the matter in a respectful, constructive way, normally within a few days.
2. Group meeting	The issue is put on the agenda of the next group meeting. The group agrees on concrete, measurable corrective actions with a deadline, and records them in the minutes.
3. Written warning	If the agreed actions are not followed, the group gives a written warning by e-mail to the members, describing the breach and what must change. The warning is sent by e-mail, not on Discord, and a copy is kept by the coordinator.
4. Supervisor	If the situation is still unresolved, the coordinator contacts the supervisor / course coordinator and presents the documentation. The course staff decide on further consequences.

Examples of breaches of this contract: repeated unannounced absence, repeatedly missing internal deadlines without notice, not responding to messages for several days, not contributing a fair share of the work, or submitting work that violates academic integrity.

12. Absence, illness and unforeseen events

- Illness and other legitimate reasons are fully accepted. The only requirement is that the group is informed as soon as possible.
- When a member is unavailable, their tasks are redistributed temporarily by the coordinator and returned when the member is back.
- Longer absence (more than one week) is reported to the supervisor so that the workload and expectations can be adjusted.
- If a member withdraws from the course, the group informs the supervisor immediately and re-plans the remaining work.

13. Working environment

We work in an inclusive environment where everyone is heard, regardless of background, language or prior experience. We make sure that quieter members are explicitly invited into discussions, and that no single member dominates decisions. We respect that members have other courses, work and private obligations, and we plan accordingly rather than relying on last-minute crunch. Any form of harassment or discrimination is unacceptable and will be reported directly to the course staff.

14. Validity and amendments

This contract enters into force when all members have signed it and applies until the final portfolio submission. It can be changed at any time if all members agree; the change is recorded in the minutes, and a new version of the document is committed to /docs in the GitHub repository. We review the contract at least once, at the midpoint of the project, to check whether it still reflects how we actually work.

15. Signatures

By signing, each member confirms that they have read, understood and accepted these group rules.

Full name	Signature
Aksel Wiersdalen	Aksel Wiersdalen
Vinjar Berland	Vinjar Berland
OleMarius Glomsrud	O M G
Fredrik Svendsrud	F K S
Nikolai Stubø	Nikolai O. Stubø
Katharina Kivle	Katharina Kivle

Place and date: 11. September 2026 Version 1.0 Signed copy stored in /docs in the group's GitHub repository.